

Some useful ZF2 terminology

- **Controller:** This is a class with some actions. Controllers process, validate and execute some operations as per business and application logic, and return output.
- **View files:** Each action has a view file for rendering.
- **Router:** In any framework, the router determines which controller and specific action to execute for an incoming request.
- **onBootstrap function:** It is like *init()*, *init* initialises the current module; other modules may not have been initialised, whereas *module onBootstrap()* runs after all modules have been initialised, and it listens for different events.
- **Event manager:** This allows event driven programming. For example, dispatch, route, etc.
- **ACL:** This is a lightweight and flexible access control list, used for permissions management. It has two main objects:
 - Resource: It's an object on which access is controlled.
 - Role: It's an object which is assigned to resource.
- **Input filter:** This filters input data against different types of validations like email address, string length, trim string, etc. This is very useful for form validations and Web services.
- **View helpers:** Classes are used to perform some repeated behaviour for rendering purposes like to format dates, to generate form elements or display action links.
- **Dependency injection:** One or more dependencies are injected, or passed by reference into a dependent object. This helps the system to behave differently for a given data without modifications in code. But its code implementation is very difficult, and it is tough to trace as it separates behaviour from construction.

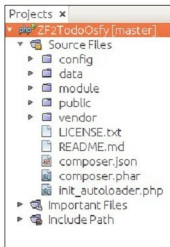


Figure 2: Typical directory structure of ZF2

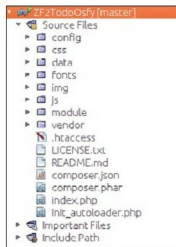


Figure 3: Typical directory structure of ZF2 for shared hosting

So, that's it. A sample ZF2 application is ready to launch. The initial home page will look like what's shown in Figure 1.

Directory structure of ZF2

The directory structure of ZF2 is shown in Figure 2.

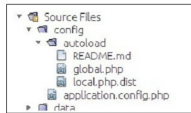


Figure 4: Config directory in ZF2

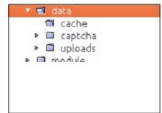


Figure 5: Data directory in ZF2

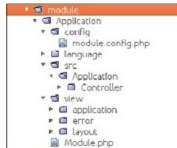


Figure 6: Module directory in ZF2

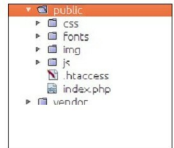


Figure 7: Public directory in ZF2



Figure 8: Vendor directory in ZF2

Note: ZF2 has a public directory in its directory structure. This directory contains publicly accessible contents like CSS, js, images, etc. Your host should be pointing to the public directory. This is to keep other code outside and unreachable from direct access. You can move the contents of the public directory outside the structure, if you are using shared hosting or there is no possibility of modifying public directory in your host. The typical directory structure for shared hosting is shown in Figure 3.

- **Config:** This directory contains all project specific configurations. Figure 4 shows the structure of the config directory.
 - *application.config.php:* This defines the modules used for the project, which configuration files to include, and the path to the module and vendor.
 - *autoload:* This directory contains configuration files for the project. Environment-specific configuration files can be created. For a specific environment, only the environment-specific file will be included.
 - *global.php:* Global constants can be added here.
 - *local.php:* Database connection and other configuration can be done from this file.
- **Data:** This directory contains Captcha, cached files and uploaded files. Figure 5 shows the structure of the data directory.
- **Module:** This directory contains all the modules for the project.

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